

**ASSESSMENT OF PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL PRACTICE (IN CASE OF
COOPRATIVE BANK OF OROMIA ASSELA BRANCH)**

**A RESEARCH PAPER SUBMITTED TO THE DEPARTMENT OF
MANAGEMENT IN PARTIAL FULFILLMENT OF THE REQUIREMENT FOR
THE BACHELOR OF ARTS IN DEGREE**



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Abstract

Performance appraisal process is a key contributor to successful HRM, as it is highly related to organizational performance. The administrative purpose of performance appraisal can also be used as a motivational tool by recognizing successful performance and rewarding; whereas the developmental purpose guides on the required skills, competences and behaviors by providing trainings. In line with this, the study tried to assess the performance appraisal practice of cooperative bank of Asella branch by applying descriptive research method and with specific objectives of looking in to the effectiveness, the process, problems of performance appraisal practice and assessing the employees perception towards the fairness of performance appraisal practice of the bank. The reearcher has used descriptive research method. The data collection tools were based on questionnaire. The population of interest consists all 14 employees of academic staff in Cooperative Bank of Oromia in Asella branch. The study uses census survey and also uses descriptive analysis method to analysis the data obtained from primary and secondary source of data will used in this study.

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CHAPTRE ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.1. Background of the Study

Human resource is a vital for the performance of any organization. As all the objectives and goals of the organization are set as well as realize by people, positive contribution of individuals is a major input for the organizations survival and also the source of sustainable competitive advantage (Wright, Dunford, and Snell, 2001 cited by Aleassa, 2014).In today s competitive business world, it is becoming clear that organizations can compete in the market only by innovation which will be attained by managing their human resource in a good way. Employees are considered as a valuable asset to an organization that requires effective management. It is possible to make human resource system effective by having a valid and accurate appraisal system (Femi, 2013).

According to Dattner (2010) cited by Gichuhi, Abaja&Ochieng (2012), a well-designed performance appraisal system has first to develop a criteria for successful performance; which consist of the desired outputs expected of employees , then give performance feedback and have a fair reward system. Performance appraisal is the most powerful instrument that the organizations have to mobilize the energy of every employee of the enterprise

towards the achievement of strategic goals.

Performance appraisal is a method by which the immediate line manager or the supervisor evaluates the job performance of an employee in terms of quality, quantity, cost and time (Akinbowale, Jinabhai&Lourens, 2013). According to Saeed& co-workers (2013) performance appraisal is actually an evaluation and acknowledgement of an employee s performance with certain responsibilities

ndKuppusamy, S. (2014). Impact of Performance Appraisal System on Job Satisfaction, Employee Engagement, Organizational Citizenship Behavior and Productivity, Indian Journal of Applied Research, Vol. 4, Issue 2, pp. 4-6.

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Femi, A. F. (2013). Perception of Performance Appraisal and Workers Performance in Wema Bank Headquarters, Lagos, Global Journal of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences, Vol.1, No.4, pp. 89-101. formance as objectively as possible in which the results of it will be used in setting direction for the development of the individual performance by identifying the performance strength and weakness and then developing an action plan to bring the desired development (Gichuhi, Abaja and Ochieng, 2012).

A performance appraisal which is not carefully developed and implemented can have negative repercussions for both the organization and its employees; some of them may be getting the wrong person promoted, transferred or fired; it may also cause feelings of inequality on the part of good employees who erroneously rises than bad employees. It could lead to legal suits in which the organization has a very weak defense for why a particular individual will not promoted. Also it could result dissatisfied employees who could decrease their effort on work which has a negative impact on the customers or they may look for other jobs. According to Nurse (2005) cited by Akinbowale, Jinabhai&Lourens (2013), even if performance appraisal has many benefits to the organization, it has also an equal probability of having a

bad impact to both the organization and employee performance. Mackey and Johnson (2000) have stated that as performance appraisal has the capability in improving the work performance and employee satisfaction, it is also capable of demotivating employees and creating bad impression on good employees (cited by - Akinbowale, Jinabhai&Lourens, 2013).The bank is conducting performance appraisal twice a year on January for the period covering from July up to December and July for the period covering from January to June.

1.2. Statement of the Problem

Assessment of employees performance is one of the common practices in almost every organization as it is an essential trend to brought better performance of employees and organizations as well. In creating better performance of the organization, satisfied employees play a crucial role (Karimi, Malik &Hussain, 2011).Employee satisfaction with job is pleasurable or positive emotional state resulting when one s personal expectations at work are in line with the outcome (Sharma &Khanna, 2014; Khan, 2007 cited by Karimi, Malik &Hussain, 2011).Performance appraisal practices, if performed correctly and logically are now considered as one of the key contributing factors to the success of an organization. Organizations have to put increased emphasize on performance appraisal to identify the strengths and weaknesses of their employees, to improve their productivity which in turn helps the organizations to gain competitive advantage with human resource(Femi 2013).

However, if it is abused and misused, appraisals can be a great source of dissatisfaction that obstruct employee motivation. While conducting interview with seven employees who are on no managerial positions of the bank complaints have been presented towards the appraisal system of the bank in which current appraisal results of the employees are based on their past result and are similar to their past as the appraiser didn t see the current performance of the employees.

Moreover, some of them believed that, the appraisal practice goes from end

to the start point as the supervisors or managers decide the final result at first and then allocate it to the various appraising criteria and while doing it sometimes they may give contrary result for similar criteria. In addition to the above, these employees have also complained that most of the supervisor or manager gives the result based on the employee's relation or closeness towards them. Due to these complaints, the researcher is motivated to assess the existing performance appraisal practice of the bank.

From this research we would fill the gap out of they said, we would solve the problem on an essential trends brought the better performance employees in the organization are

- Appreciate the lower performance employees for high quality.
- By equally treating and fairness of employees.
- to give incentive for increasing their performance.

1.3. Research Questions

1. What does performance appraisal process of the bank look like?
2. What methods does the organization use to evaluate its employees?
3. What are the major problems in performance appraisal practice of the bank?

1.4. Objectives of the Study

1.4.1. General objective

The study would be conducted with the general objective of assessing performance appraisal practice in cooperative bank Oromia in Asella branch.

1.4.2. Specific objective

Based on the general objectives of the study the specific objectives of the study would be:

- To examine the effectiveness of performance appraisal system of bank;
- To assess the performance appraisal process of the bank;
- To assess the major problems in performance appraisal practice of the bank;

1.5. Scope of the Study

The scope of this study to the assessment performance appraisal practice in case of cooperative bank of oromia Assela branch. The scope of the study on cooperative bank of oromia and geographically limited to Arsi zone Asella branch. Methodologically this researchers will employees qualitative research approach with descriptive method.

1.6. Significance of the Study

The findings of this research would be used by the bank as an input for assessing its performance appraisal practice and its employees perception towards the fairness of performance appraisal system so that it can identifies the areas needing improvement. The study would also be used as a basis for further researcher to conduct on this area. Besides it would serve as a reference material for both academicians and practitioners.

CHAPTE TWO

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE

2.1. The Concept of Performance Appraisal

Performance appraisal can be defined as a structured formal annual or semi-annual interaction between the subordinate and supervisor to examine and discuss the work performance of the subordinate by identifying strength and weakness as well as opportunities for improvement and skill development (Bhatia & Jain, 2012).

Performance appraisal is the process of obtaining, analyzing and recording information about the worth of an employee so as to evaluate the performance and understand the abilities of an employee for further growth and development (Manjunath, 2015).

Lansbury (1988) defined performance appraisal as the process of

identifying, evaluating and developing the work performance of employees in the organization, so that the organizational goals and objectives are more effectively achieved, while at the same time benefiting employees in terms of recognition, receiving feedback, catering for work needs and offering career guidance. cited by (Seniwoliba, 2014: 601).

Deepa&Kuppusamy (2014) defines performance appraisal as a process in which the work performance of the employee is identified as strength and weakness so that the organization could use it in providing proper training to them and improve the organizations performance.

According to Khan (2013: 66) performance appraisal as a formal, structured system of meaning and evaluating an employee s job related behavior and outcome to discover how and why the employee is presently performing on the job and he the employee can perform more effectively in the future so that the employee, organization and society get the benefit.

2.2. Purpose of Performance Appraisal

Performance appraisal is taken as the most important and crucial tools for the organization as it provides information which is very useful for decision making about different personnel aspects like promotions and merit increases (Obisi, 2011).

Gomez-Mejia and coworkers (2012) state that appraisals are usually performed for administrative and /or development purposes.

.Performance appraisal serves a number of purposes in organizations. In general terms performance appraisal has two roles in organization, which are often seen as potentially conflicting. These are administrative and developmental roles. Performance appraisals can be sometimes conducted for personnel research purpose (Mathis and Jackson, pp.344).those who favor formal performance evaluation contained that it serves several proposes, which are essentially extensions of the above to major roles (Ivancevich&Glueck, 1989, and Robins, 1996). The following are some of them.

Developmental purpose: PA can determine which employees need more training and helps evaluate the results of training programs. It helps the subordinate-supervisor counseling relationship, and encourages supervisors to observe subordinate behavior to help employees.

Motivational purposes: the presence of an evaluation program has a motivational effect: it encourages initiative, develops a sense of responsibility, and stimulates effort to perform better.

Reward and compensation purpose: PA helps the organization decide who should receive pay raise and promotions. It can determine who will be laid off. It reinforces the employee's motivation to perform more effectively.

2.3. The Performance Appraisal Process

If a systematic performance appraisal process is followed, the ability to generate accurate and reliable data would be enhanced as a result the information that can serve the organizations goals and that compiles with the law would be provided (Ivancevich, 2004). According to Rao & Rani (2014), unfair procedures of the performance appraisal create job dissatisfaction.

Manjunath (2015) has listed the following steps for developing such systematic process;

- Establishing Performance Standards
- Communicating Standards and Expectations
- Measuring the Actual Performance
- Comparing the Actual with the Desired Performance
- Discussing Results
- Decision Making

Source: Adopted from Manjunath (2015)

2.4. Performance Appraisal Methods

Since employees appraisal system is used as a basis for successful employee

performance management and also provides valuable information to other HRM functions, it has to be properly designed and realized (Aggarwal and Thakur, 2013).

There are a number of methods available to measure the employee's performance. These methods can be broadly classified into two groups: traditional methods (past oriented) and modern methods (future oriented) (Aggarwal and Thakur, 2013; Shaout and Yousif, 2014).

2.4.1. Traditional performance methods

Traditional methods are relatively older methods of performance appraisals which are based on the personal qualities of the employee including the knowledge, initiative, loyalty, leadership and judgment. These methods were past oriented approaches which concentrated only on the past performance (Aggarwal and Thakur, 2013).

Graphical rating scale

It is a popular and simple method used to compare individual performance to an absolute standard. It is a scale which lists traits such as quality and reliability and the range of performance values from unacceptable to outstanding. The employee is then graded by identifying the score that best defines his or her level of performance for the trait (Lunenburg, 2012; Shaout and Yousif, 2014).

Ranking method

It is an alternative method to graphic rating scale in which the employees are ranked based on their performance effectiveness one after the other from best to worst (Shaout and Yousif, 2014). According to Lunenburg (2012), the usual procedure in ranking method is that the rater will write the name of the best subordinate on the top of list, then the worst at the bottom and continue this sequential procedure until all the subordinates are listed.

. Paired comparison method

This is a method where each employee is paired with every other employee in the same framework and then the raters make a two-way comparison. This is a useful method only where the number of comparisons made is less

otherwise it will become ineffective when the number of employees increases (Khan, 2013; Lunenburg, 2012).

. Grading method

In this method, certain categories of grading of performance like excellent, very good, average, poor, very poor etc would be defined in advance and employees are put in a particular category depending on their traits and characteristics. However, this method has one basic limitation which is the rater is give higher grades for most of the employees (Khan, 2013).

2.4.2. Modern performance appraisal methods

Modern methods of performance appraisal were developed to improve the limitations like biasness and subjectivity of the traditional methods (Ashima and Thakur, 2013; Yousif and Shaout, 2014).

Management by objective (MBO)

Management by objective is a result oriented process in which first supervisor and subordinate jointly establish objectives and individual area of responsibility, then the employee performance would be measured by examining the extent to which predetermined work objectives have been met (Khan, 2013). In management by objectives, as performance is evaluated based on the achievement of the established objectives, it could be said that this method of appraisal is mostly concerned about the results achieved or goals attained but not the ways on how the employees performed it (Khanna and Sharma, 2014).

2.5. Performance appraisal errors

Evaluating another individuals performance accurately and fairly is not an easy thing to do; moreover, errors often result in this process. According to Rao and Rani (2014), performance appraisals are designed for assessing the performance and potential of employees, however due a variety of limitations on their use, it may not be a valid indicator of what they are intended to asses. Performance appraisal errors affect the validity and dependability of

the performance appraisal system, and they could be discussed as follows:

Judgment error

Performance appraisal is HRM activity which entails teamwork between line managers or supervisors and HR specialists. The appraiser is supposed to have detail knowledge about the job content, the contents to be appraised and standards of content. Evaluators may commit mistakes due to the biasness and inadequate training and these errors are called rater errors or judgmental errors (Rao and Rani, 2014).

Stereotyping

It is when the rater overestimates or underestimates the employees performance based on the generalization made to the employees behavior on the mental picture of rater about the sex, age, religion and the like (Rao and Rani, 2014).

Poor appraisal forms

The appraisal process is affected by the appraisal forms to be used. If there is ambiguity and lack of clarity in the rating scale or if the forms are too long and complex, they can cause perceptual difference in the meaning of the words used to evaluate employees. The rating form may also ignore important aspects of the job performance (Rao and Rani, 2014).

Ineffective organizational policies and practices

Most of the time, the sincere appraisal report is not suitably rewarded and this diminish the motivation to perform the job thoroughly and sincerely (Rao and Rani, 2014).

2.6. Requirements of Effective Appraisal System

Performance appraisal process is a key contributor to successful HRM as it is highly related to the organizational performance (Erdogan, 2002 cited by Rao and Rani, 2014).

According to Beardwell and Claydon, (2007) cited by Wangithi and Muceke (2012), an incorporated and effective appraisal system could increase

organizational performance and employee motivation. It recognizes successful performance and guides on the required skills, competences and behaviors to meet the expectation.

In order to develop an effective performance appraisal system, the raters should be trained on the process of managing, motivating and evaluating employee performance (Goff & Longenecker, 1990 cited by Ochoti and coworkers, 2012). The key requirements for sound appraisal system would be discussed as follows:

Relevance: implies that there is a clear relation between the performance standards and organization's goals and also clear links among the crucial job elements and the dimensions to be rated on an appraisal form (Khan, 2013; Cascio, 2003).

Sensitivity: the performance appraisal system is capable of distinguishing high performers from low performers in which the high and low performers receive criterion scores that precisely represent the variation in their performance (Ivancevich, 2004; Cascio, 2003).

Reliability: implies consistency of judgment in which appraisals for any given employee made by different raters must reach to similar conclusions about the quality of that worker's output (Ivancevich, 2004; Cascio, 2003).

Acceptability: is the most important requirement of all as the appraisal systems that are acceptable to those who would be affected by them guide to more favorable reactions to the process and also enhance trust for top management (Cascio, 2003).

Practicality: Understanding and using the appraisal instruments are easy for managers and employees that is the criterion is measurable and the data collection is efficient (Ivancevich, 2004; Cascio, 2003).

2.7. Employees' Perceptions on Performance Appraisal

In managing organizations effectively, it is important to any top management to set accurate performance appraisal system and meet the employees' perception of fairness. Perception of performance appraisal procedure unfairness could have an adverse effect on employees

organizational commitment, job satisfaction, trust in management, performance, work-related stress, and theft. (According to Ochoti and coworkers (2012) employee reaction to the performance appraisal system is significant aspect to the acceptance as well as effectiveness of the system.

Employees most likely perceive the performance appraisal as accurate and fair when; appraisals are conducted frequently, there is a formal system of appraisal, supervisors have high degree of job knowledge, there is opportunity for the rates to appeal, performance dimensions are seen highly relevant, and when there is formulating action plans to deal with present weakness (Murphy & Cleveland, 1995 ; Murphy & Cleveland, 1995 and Landy et al, 1978 cited by Ochoti and coworkers, 2012).

2.8. Research Gap

most past research will focused on the study of performance appraisal process, performance appraisal practice, the impact of performance evaluation on the moral and satisfaction of employee, effect of performance appraisal on the employee productivity and the role of performance appraisal for both employee and the organization. But in this study the researcher is motivated only to assess the major serious problems of performance evaluation that affecting the effectiveness and efficiency of both the employee and the organization to achieve the stated objectives of a given organization.

The researcher aims to address the gaps in previous research by focusing on the major problems affecting the effectiveness and efficiency of performance evaluation. This study is motivated by the desire to assess these problems and their impact on both employees and organizations in achieving their objectives.

CHAPTER THREE

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1. Description of the Study area

Cooperative Bank of Oromia is one of the private banks existing Ethiopia in general and some regions in particular. The bank has also different districts and branches all over the country. The specific area of this research is Cooperative bank of Oromia Asella branch which is located in Asella Town,. addition, the bank provides different services like deposit, local money transfer services (E-banking, card banking, Mobile banking, Internet banking) interest free banking (and financing services(local or international transfer, International Trade service and so on. During the year, 2016 E.C the bank has 14 employees .

3.2 Research design

In this study the researches will use a descriptive method through census in order to undertake the study in predetermined time periods the periods of employing this method is to describe the performance appraisal system and its role on employee performance of a Cooperative bank of Oromia Asella branch. The researchers undertaken to use this kinds of research considering desire to obtain first hand data from the respondents and to give sound conclusion and recommendation for the study.

3.3 Source data

In this study both primarily and secondary data were used to achieve the expectations of this paper. Primarily source of data (a document that is being reported first hand or original sources, not interpretations made by someone else) were collected from an employee of Cooperative bank of Oromia are working in Asella branch through questionnaire (that contains both open and closed questions developed by researchers.

Secondary source of data were collect through related literature such as different human resource books and records, internet, document, different written materials in a bank regarding the topic of the study.

3.4. Data collection Method

The data for this study were collected through by distributing a questionnaire both open ended and closed ended (open ended means questions give your audience an opportunity to express their opinions in a free following manner and closed ended questions means prepared multiple choice questions where respondents are restricted to the choice among any of the given multiple choice answers) to the respondent.

3.5. sampling techniques

The target population of this particular study were comprised all employees of Cooperative bank of Oromia in Asella branch because the overall members of employees of cooperative bank of oromia in Asella branch is 14 employees. so there is no need of taking sampling size. The method of the researcher interested to use for conducting the study will census method. The reason that initiate the researcher to use census method are highly reliable and yields much information. In general data derived through census are accurate because it addresses all the entire available employees in the bank.

3.6. Data analysis and presentation

The researchers used descriptive analysis method in order to analyze the data collected through questionnaires because descriptive data analysis method helps to reduce the collected data in to summery format and raw data into a form that makes in to them easy to understand and interpret . So this method the raw data were converted in to understandable form.

3.7 TIME AND COST SCHEDULE

3.7.1 TIME SCHEDULE

It describes the plan of assessing the ongoing progress toward achieving the research objectives. It specifies how each project activity is to be measured in terms of completion, the time line for its completion. In order to perform our task in timely manner and to monitor our project progress and to provide timely feedback for our research modification or adjustment we provide the following time plan.

Activity		December	January	February	March	April
Study area selection		↗				
Topic selection		↗				
Data collection			↗			
Data analysis			↗			
Writing proposal				↗		
Proposal submission						
Presentation of final proposal			.			

COST BUDGET

This shows that how much cost will be use to conduct the research. it states cost of every budget items that should be quantitatively shown typically, our proposal cost budget includes different costs such as:- personnel consumable supplies, travel, communication, publication and so on

No	Items	Quantity	Per unit cost in br.	Total cost (birr)
1	Paper	35	2	70
2	Pen	2	25	50
3	Flash	1	350	350
4	Printing	35	3	105
5	Binding	1	30	30
6	Transportation	3	30	90
7	Miscellaneous expense			400
Total				1,095

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